PRD: dannyockilson.com

Version

v1.0 — Draft

Vision

A personal website built around two distinctive interactions: a Snellen-chart-inspired typographic grid that serves as both loading state and site identity, and a conversational search prompt that replaces traditional navigation. The name "Danny Ockilson" rendered at scale C c the brand — no logo, no hero image. The site's personality comes through in the question it asks you: "I am Danny Ockilson. You chose to come here... why?"

Goals

1. **Identity through interaction** — the intro animation and the search prompt together form the entire first impression. No template energy. No generic portfolio site.
2. **Animation as functional UI** — the name grid plays on first visit as an identity moment, and on subsequent visits only when content needs async loading time. It masks latency while reinforcing brand.
3. **Navigation through intent** — visitors declare what they're looking for rather than scanning a menu. This filters the site through the visitor's purpose and creates space for personality (canned responses, Easter eggs).
4. **Low-friction publishing** — MDX in a git repo. Push to deploy. No CMS.
5. **Mobile-first** — the grid layout was designed for portrait viewports. Desktop is the adaptation.

for landscape flip to

Non-Goals

- CMS or visual editor.
- Comments, social features, analytics dashboard. → THIS WOULD BE NICE (AT LEAST TRACKING)
- LLM-powered search routing (future enhancement, not v1).
- A "complete" portfolio site on day one — ship the grid + search + writing first, iterate.

Aesthetic Direction

Snellen eye chart as the primary reference. This means:

- Black/near-black text on white/cream background. High contrast.
- Letters are the visual architecture. No visible grid lines, no card borders, no coloured blocks.
- Size hierarchy creates structure — large letters dominate, smaller text is subordinate. The grid's spatial relationships are communicated through type size and spacing alone.
- Monospace or geometric/optotype-inspired typeface.
- Potential to layer in deeper Snellen-specific references (red/green duochrome accents, the classic chart tapering shape) — to be explored in design prototyping. Start typographic, add references if they feel right.

Visual System: Duochrome Bars

The Snellen red/green duochrome test provides a functional visual element beyond just aesthetic reference. Horizontal coloured bars (green and red) appear throughout the UI as:

- **Structural dividers** between content sections on pages
- **Result type indicators** in search results (green = top/primary match, red = secondary/additional results)
- **Framing elements** around the search input on the home page (green bar above, red bar below — or vice versa, to be explored)

These bars replace traditional horizontal rules, card borders, or section separators. They're the only colour in an otherwise black-and-white palette, which makes them visually powerful without being decorative.

Content Architecture

Routes

Route	Content	Source
	Intro animation → home page with search prompt	Astro component (hand-curated)
Z U L W L Q J	Blog index. Reverse-chron, titles + dates + optional tags.	Content Collection query
Z U L W L Q J > V O X J @	Individual post. Full MDX rendering.	MDX file

Route	Content	Source
`SURMHFWV`	Project index.	Content Collection query
`SURMHFWV>VOXJ@`	Individual project page.	MDX file

Content Model (MDX Frontmatter)

ADD THIS

Experiments/toys/easter eggs ...
- small, embedded apps on the page
- can exist in isolation
- can be added to 'writing' pages

LATER EDIT

writing -> status + template + mdx
Projects -> references + template + mdx
Custom -> JUST MDX

Writing:

```
WLWOWHWULQJ
GDWH,62 GDWH
WDJVWULQJ>@  RSWLRQDO
GHVFULSWLRQ  PHWD 2*
GUDIWERROHDQ  GHIDXOW IDOVH
```

Projects:

```
WLWOWHWULQJ
GHVFULSWLRQ
WDJVWULQJ>@
XUOVWULQJ  RSWLRQDO  OLYH OLQN
UHSRVWULQJ  RSWLRQDO  *LW+XE OLQN
IHDWXUHGERROHDQ  GHIDXOW IDOVH
GDWH,62 GDWH
```

The Name Grid

Structure

The name is displayed as two typographic blocks:

- **OCKILSON** — vertical stack, one letter per row, left side
- **DANNY** — arranged in a compact grid (roughly 2 columns × 3 rows), right side, vertically centred against OCKILSON

No visible grid lines. Letter sizing follows a Snellen-inspired hierarchy — larger letters in DANNY (it's the first name, the "big E" at the top of the chart), smaller letters in OCKILSON. Spacing and alignment imply the grid structure.

Two States

DANNY GOES HERE

Expanded (intro/loading): Full-screen. Letters at maximum scale. This is the only thing on screen.

surname as L shaped frame

Collapsed (content view): OCKILSON shrinks to a narrow vertical element on the left edge. DANNY shrinks to a small badge in the top-right corner. The content area fills the remaining space. Below the DANNY badge: configurable icon links (social/contact — specific platforms TBD).

Animation Behaviour

First visit to `/`:

1. Full-screen name grid renders.
2. Grid assembles/settles (animation ~1–1.5s).
3. Grid collapses: OCKILSON to left sidebar, DANNY to top-right badge.
4. Home page content (search prompt + curated content) fades into the revealed content area.
5. Icon links appear beneath DANNY badge.

Return visit (same session): No animation. Collapsed grid + home content renders immediately.

Return visit (new session, content cached/fast): No animation. Immediate render.

Return visit (new session, content loading): Animation plays as a loading state. Collapses once content is ready.

Deep link (e.g. `Z U L W L Q J  V R P H`): Collapsed grid renders immediately as the persistent frame. No intro animation.

`S U H I H U V  U H G X F H G  Q`: Skip all animation. Hard-cut to collapsed state.

Navigation System

see previous comment on wording

Primary: Search Prompt

The home page content area displays:

Heading: "I am Danny Ockilson. You chose to come here... why?"

Below the heading: Green duochrome bar, search input, red duochrome bar (Snellen-inspired framing).

The search prompt is the primary navigation mechanism. Users type what they're looking for and the system resolves their intent.

Search Resolution (Priority Order)

1. **Canned responses** — exact or near-exact matches against a manually curated map of queries → responses/routes. This includes:

2. FAQ-style entries (e.g. "hire" → route to a contact/availability page or canned response)
3. Easter eggs (e.g. specific phrases that trigger hidden content, interactive components, or jokes)
4. Common intents (e.g. "blog", "writing", "projects" → route directly to those indexes)
5. **Fuzzy content match** — search query matched against content titles, tags, and descriptions using client-side fuzzy search (e.g. Fuse.js). Returns ranked results.
6. **No match fallback** — friendly message with suggested categories / popular content.

Search Results Layout

- **Search input** stays pinned at top of content area.
- **Top match** is displayed prominently — large title, takes up significant space. If confidence is high enough (exact canned match or single fuzzy result), auto-navigates directly to the target page instead of showing this view.
- **Additional results** listed below, each separated by a coloured duochrome bar. Smaller treatment than the top match.
- **"Search again"** link/button at the bottom of results, returns focus to the search input.

Future Enhancement: LLM Routing

The canned response + fuzzy match system is the v1 implementation. The architecture should be designed so that an LLM-powered intent resolver can be slotted in as an additional resolution step (between canned and fuzzy, or replacing fuzzy) without changing the UI. This would allow natural language queries like "what do you think about CSS-in-JS" to surface relevant blog posts.

Secondary: Fallback Navigation

Remember preference for next visit?

- After leaving the home page, a **search icon** appears alongside the social/contact icons beneath the DANNY badge. Clicking it returns to with the search prompt focused.
- On the home page, while the search input is focused/active, a **"just give me a menu" link** fades in after a short delay (~2–3 seconds). This opens a floating nav overlay listing Writing and Projects (and any future sections). The delay is intentional — the search prompt is the intended interaction; the menu is a safety net, not a primary affordance.

Navigation on Content Pages

Once on a content page (Z U L W L Q J > V, etc.), the persistent frame (OCKILSON sidebar + DANNY badge + icons + search icon) provides:

- **DANNY badge or site name** → link back to
- **Search icon** → link back to with search focused
- Standard content-level navigation (next/prev post, back to index) lives within the content area, not in the persistent frame.

The DANNY Badge (Post-Collapse)

After grid collapse, the DANNY block in the top-right corner is a persistent UI element across all pages:

- Letters maintain their mini-grid arrangement (2×2-ish) at small scale
- Functions as a home link (click →)
- Below it: a vertical stack of icon links:
- Social/contact icons (platforms TBD, spec as generic configurable list)
- Search icon (appears after navigating away from home)
- On mobile: DANNY badge may need to be smaller than desktop to preserve content space. Icons may collapse into a single "..." or similar.

Content Page Template

Per the wireframe (using Void Screamer as the reference example):

- **Title** — large, Snellen-scale typography at the top of the content area
- **Description/subtitle** — smaller text below title
- **Green duochrome bar** — divider
- **Body content** — MDX-rendered prose, images, code blocks, embedded React components
- **Red duochrome bar** — divider
- **Embedded app/interactive section** (optional) — React island embedded via MDX. For project pages this might be a live demo. For Easter eggs, it could be the actual interactive experience. "Open app "" links out to standalone deployed versions where applicable.

The template should feel consistent but the content within it is fully flexible thanks to MDX + React islands.

Embedded React Islands in MDX

A core feature of the site is the ability to embed interactive applications directly within content pages. This is not an edge case — it's a primary use case for both project showcases and Easter egg responses.

Examples

- **Project pages**: live demos embedded inline (e.g. Void Screamer playable directly on its project page, with an "Open app "" link to a standalone version)
- **Easter egg search results**: search triggers that render interactive components instead of static text (e.g. typing a specific phrase loads a mini-game or visual experience in the content area)
- **Blog posts**: interactive code demos, data visualisations, or illustrative tools embedded alongside prose

MDX makes this native — a blog post can `LPSRu` a React component and render it inline. Astro's `FOLHQd` directives control when the JS loads (on page load, on visible, on idle, etc.).

JS Policy

Minimal framework JS by default — Astro's island architecture means pages only ship JS for interactive components. Content pages ship no JS n N I 3 the MDX embeds a React component (which is expected and encouraged). The site should embrace MDX's ability to embed interactive mini-apps, demos, and Easter egg components directly in posts and project pages. This is a feature, not an exception.

Canned Response System

A JSON/TypeScript config file mapping trigger phrases to actions:

```
W\SH&DQQHG5HVSRQVH
  _ ^ W\SH QDYLJDWH WKH WULQJ
  _ ^ W\SH PHVVDJH WH[W WULQJ
  _ ^ W\SH UHGLUHFW WR VWULQJ
  _ ^ W\SH FRPSRQHQW FRPSRQHQW WULQJ SURSV 5HFRUG WULQJ &QQRZQ

FRQVW &DQQHG5HVSRQVH &RQIRUP &RQVW &DQQHG5HVSRQVH
    &RPPRQ LQWHQWV
  EORJ     ^ W\SH QDYLJDWH WKH ZULWLQ`J
  ZULWLQJ^ W\SH QDYLJDWH WKH ZULWLQ`J
  SURMHFW^VW\SH QDYLJDWH WKH SURMHFW V
  KLUH     ^ W\SH PHVVDJH WH[W `
  FY       ^ W\SH QDYLJDWH WKH FY `    LI ZKHQ WKLV H[LVWV
  FRQWDFW^ W\SH PHVVDJH WH[W `

    (DVWHU HJJV
       WR EH SRSXODWHG
`
```

MAKE ALL CONTENT FILE BASED (MD/MDX)

EVEN WHEN NO URL USED

Matching should be case-insensitive and support partial/fuzzy matching (e.g. "writ" matches "writing"). Canned responses are checked $ 3 8 Fuzzy content search so they take priority.

User Flows

Flow 1: First-Time Visitor

1. Arrives at `/`. Full-screen name grid animates in.
2. Grid collapses. Home content reveals: heading ("I am Danny Ockilson..."), search input framed by duochrome bars, and hand-curated home content below.
3. Visitor types "blog" → auto-navigates to `/ZULWLQJ`
4. Reads blog index. OCKILSON sidebar + DANNY badge + search icon visible as persistent frame.
5. Clicks a post → `/ZULWLQJ/VRPH-VOXJ` Reads it.
6. Clicks DANNY badge → returns to `/`. No animation (same session). Search prompt visible.

Flow 2: Return Visitor (Same Session)

1. Navigates to `/`. No animation. Home content with search prompt renders immediately.
2. Types a query → results or direct navigation.

for the loading screen transitions

Flow 3: Return Visitor (New Session, Slow Connection)

1. Navigates to `/`. Content needs loading. Name grid animation plays as loading indicator.
2. Content ready → grid collapses → home content reveals.

Flow 4: Deep Link from Search Engine

1. Arrives at `/ZULWLQJ/VRPH-VOXJ`. Collapsed grid frame renders immediately.
2. Reads content. Notices DANNY badge, search icon, social links in top-right.
3. Clicks search icon → navigates to `/` with search focused.

maybe other frustration signals?

Flow 5: Frustrated User

1. Arrives at `/`. Animation plays. Search prompt appears.
2. Stares at search input. Doesn't want to type.
3. After ~2–3 seconds, "just give me a menu" link fades in.
4. Clicks it → floating nav overlay appears with Writing / Projects.
5. Clicks Writing → navigates to `/ZULWLQJ` → Nested 'home page' here

more dynamic area (latest, popular etc...)

Flow 6: Easter Egg

1. Visitor types a specific phrase into search (e.g. a known Easter egg trigger).
2. Canned response triggers — could be a direct page, a rendered component, a message, a visual gag, a redirect. Behaviour is per-egg.

Mobile Considerations

- **Grid animation:** Designed mobile-first. The two-block layout (OCKILSON left, DANNY right) works in portrait. Collapsed state: OCKILSON becomes a very narrow left strip, DANNY badge is small in top-right corner. Content area gets maximum space.
- **DANNY badge size:** Smaller on mobile than desktop. May need to reduce the letter grid to just "D" or a minimal mark on very narrow viewports.
- **Search input:** Full-width in the content area. Standard mobile keyboard interaction.
- **"Just give me a menu" button:** Same behaviour as desktop. Floating nav overlay is touch-friendly.
- **Icon links:** May need to collapse or reduce on very narrow viewports.

Technical Constraints

STILL WANT TYPESCRIPT OVER JS

- **Static site** — SSG output, no server required at runtime.
- **Minimal framework JS** — Astro island architecture. Pages only ship JS for embedded React components. Many pages s Chalve interactive islands; this is by design.
- **MDX** for all authored content, with embedded React components as a first-class pattern.
- **Typed frontmatter** — build-time validation of content schema.
- **Git-push deploy** — no manual build/deploy steps.

Success Metrics

1. The site exists and is live.
2. The animation feels polished and intentional, not gimmicky.
3. The search prompt is actually usable — people can find content through it.
4. Danny publishes at least one blog post within the first month.
5. The site doesn't look like any other developer portfolio.
6. All content is served as md (based on headers) for AI agents

Implementation Phases

Phase	Scope	Notes
1. Foundation	Astro setup, Content Collections, content layouts, MDX pipeline, deploy pipeline. Static collapsed-grid layout (no animation). Home page with search prompt (canned responses + fuzzy search).	Gets a functional site live. Search works. Content renders.
2. Grid Animation	Name grid component in both states. GSAP intro animation. Session-aware animation logic (play/skip). Loading-state behaviour. S U H I H U V U H G X F H G P R W L.R Q	The identity layer. Site goes from "functional" to "distinctive".
3. Polish	Snellen aesthetic refinement (typography, spacing, duochrome bar treatment). Mobile refinements (DANNY badge sizing, touch targets). OG images, meta tags, favicon, RSS feed, 404 page. + DARK MODE SUPPORT (INVERT COLOURS)	The craft layer.
4. Personality	Easter eggs (including interactive component-type responses). Canned response library. "Just give me a menu" delayed reveal. Refined search fallback messaging.	The delight layer.

+ CONTENT

Open Questions

1. **Exact wording of the prompt** — "I am Danny Ockilson. You chose to come here... why?" is the current working copy. Could also be shorter ("Why are you here?") or longer. Tone calibration needed.
2. **Snellen depth** — start with typographic approach (size hierarchy, high contrast B&W, monospace/optotype font) and explore duochrome red/green accents and chart-shape references in prototyping. The duochrome bars are confirmed as a UI element; the question is how far to push the broader Snellen aesthetic.
3. **Social/contact links** — specific platforms TBD. Architecture supports a configurable icon list beneath the DANNY badge. LinkedIn + Github
4. **Home page curated content** — what goes below the search prompt on ? Brief intro line + latest post + featured project? Or just the prompt? To be decided during Phase 1.
5. **CV/Resume route** — may want this eventually. Not in v1 scope.
6. **LLM search upgrade path** — v1 is canned + fuzzy. When/if to add LLM routing is a future decision. Architecture should not preclude it.

'WHAT DO YOU WANT?'
'NICE TO SEE YOU AGAIN' SECOND VISIT
'YOU AGAIN??' MULTIPLE VISITS
'Whats a bot like you doing in a place like this'
'What do YOU THINK you are doing!?'
↳ SUSPICIOUS ACTIVITY LIKE COMMON CMS ROUTES ETC

collection of text content and React islands